

STARFALL

THE ASCENT

Lore Bible

The foundational mythology, cosmology and hidden history

Version 1 · 11 November 2026 · Working names: several will be renamed with the Chapter 1 rewrite

Internal reference. Contains every spoiler.

READ ME FIRST

How to use this bible

This is the single source of truth for STARFALL's mythology. When a chapter, a line of dialogue or an item description touches the lore, check it against this document. If something new is decided while writing, **update the bible first**, then the script.

Tag	Meaning
[CANON]	Decided. Write against it.
[DRAFT]	Strong direction, but can still change while writing chapters.
[OPEN]	Not decided. Do not reveal or contradict it in the game yet.

Naming note
Several names here are **working names** (some Kosmokrators, NPCs and possibly playable characters). The planned renaming happens with the Chapter 1 rewrite. When a name changes, change it here and keep the old name in the Glossary under "formerly".

The thesis of the whole game:

> *"Humanity searched the stars for where they belonged. The stars were only ever meant to remind them where they came from."*

PART 1

Inspiration vs. invention

STARFALL is **inspired** by real traditions but is its own fictional religion. This table keeps us honest so we never present our inventions as "what Gnostics (or Christians) believed". None of this is shown to players directly.

Real tradition (simplified)	What STARFALL does with it
Sethian / Valentinian Gnosticism (e.g. the *Apocryphon of John*): the Monad, Aeons in pairs, Sophia's error, the Demiurge (Yaldabaoth) who creates the material world, and Archons.	**Sophia creates the physical realm; the Demiurge only orders it.** Kairos is revealed as Sophia's missing partner Aeon. These are our inventions.
Some Ophite/Sethian lists name seven planetary rulers (Yaldabaoth, Iao, Sabaoth, Adonaios, Astaphaios, Ailoaios, Horaios). The pairing of names to planets differs between sources.	We fix our own pairing and call them **Kosmokrators**. "Archon" is the heretics' word for them.
A few Gnostic readings treat the Eden serpent as a revealer of knowledge (Ophites, the *Testimony of Truth*). Mainstream Christianity does not.	The Serpent is a sliver of Kairos's divine consciousness left outside time.
Plato's Myth of Er: souls drink from Lethe (forgetting) before rebirth. Some Orphic texts tell initiates to drink from Mnemosyne (memory) instead.	**The Wheel of Return**, the Lethe springs, and Sophia Arden's "Mnemosyne Protocol".
Greek chronos (measured time) vs kairos (the decisive moment). Kronos/Saturn later merged with Chronos as "Father Time".	The Demiurge's power is measured time; Kairos is the moment outside measure.
History of the institutional Church: indulgences, inquisitions, burned or buried texts (the Nag Hammadi codices were hidden and rediscovered in 1945), relic trading.	The **Concord Church** is a fictional institution that critiques the abuse of religious power, not faith itself.

PART 2

The cosmology

The Monad [CANON]

The source of all existence. It never speaks, never acts on screen, and is never depicted. Every in-world attempt to describe it contradicts the last one. That contradiction is the point: it is beyond categories, including the categories of the chart.

The Divine Realm (the Pleroma) [CANON]

A reality **outside time**: no before, no after, no measure. Its beings are the **Aeons**, each an aspect of divine existence. Aeons exist in **pairs** (syzygies). Each half completes the other; creation is meant to happen **together**.

Sophia, the Aeon of Wisdom [CANON]

Brilliant, curious, impatient, and ashamed. She did not sin by creating. Her error was **creating alone**, without her partner. From that solitary act came two things: the **Physical Realm** (beautiful, vast, but formless and unfinished) and the being who would inhabit it, **the Demiurge**.

- She cannot enter the Physical Realm directly. Anything that enters it is **measured, numbered and charted**. If she stepped in, she would be given a birth chart and fall into the Wheel like everyone else.
- She can only reach in where time breaks: **dreams, déjà vu, eclipses, the minute between ticks**.
- Her help is sincere but not selfless. She wants to be forgiven, and she avoids admitting how much of the suffering is her doing. She is **not** a generic benevolent goddess.

Kairos, the Aeon of the Moment: Sophia's partner [DRAFT]

The deepest secret of the game. **Kairos is Sophia's missing partner**: the Aeon she did not wait for. When he saw what she had made alone, he **descended to fix it**. Entering the Physical Realm meant taking a body and being caught by the Wheel. He has been living, dying and forgetting ever since, a divine being reduced to a recurring human life.

- He is the Aeon of **the right moment** (Greek *kairos*), the opposite of the Demiurge's measured time. That is why his powers are about stopping and borrowing time.
- Because he is not one of the Demiurge's creations, the Wheel never fully holds him. Each life he remembers a little more than he should.
- This also reframes Sophia: her "mistake" and her lost partner are the same story, and the player meets the consequence as a person.

The Serpent [DRAFT]

When Kairos descended, **a small sliver of his consciousness stayed outside time**. That sliver is the Serpent. It has no body and no chart, so it can speak to humans across any era. It is the voice in Eden, the voice in Kairos's dreams ("You were there"), the voice that comments on doors.

- To the player it looks like a trickster, then a guide, then something stranger: it knows Kairos's thoughts before he has them.
- Its message is always the same: **"You have forgotten where you came from."** It is not mocking humanity. It is talking to itself.
- Final reveal: the Serpent and Kairos are one being. To become whole, Kairos must reach the part of himself that never fell.

PART 3

The Demiurge and the Celestial Order

“Sophia made the house. The Demiurge made the rules.” [CANON]

The Physical Realm Sophia made was raw: matter without law, light without rhythm. **The Demiurge gave it order**: orbits, seasons, cause and effect, and above all **time**, the measure that makes a universe predictable. His claim “I made all of this” is false, but his pride is not baseless. **Without him, creation was chaos.** He is the most gifted engineer in a universe he did not design.

Who he is [CANON]

- He woke alone in a dark, half-made universe: no parent, no explanation, no one to talk to. **He built order because he was afraid.**
- He cannot perceive the Divine Realm. To him the edge of the cosmos is the edge of existence. He sincerely believes a soul that leaves the Wheel **simply ceases to exist**. In his eyes the Wheel **saves** souls from oblivion.
- He loves his creation the way a lonely child loves a model he built: he would rather break it than let it change.
- His power is **Chronos**, measured time. His seat is **Saturn** (Kronos, Father Time), the outermost of the seven.
- In-world names: the Church calls him **the Founder** or **the First Measure**. Heretics call him **the Demiurge**. Old heretic texts use **Yaldabaoth**.

His arc: redeemable [CANON]

The Demiurge is not destroyed at the end. The final chapters move from fighting him to **reaching** him. His deepest fear is not losing power. It is learning that he is not God, and that **he has a mother who left him**. When he finally accepts the truth, he is able to **pass into the Divine Realm** himself: the first being the Wheel ever lets go willingly. His redemption is also Sophia’s: mother and son meet for the first time.

The Kosmokrators (planetary rulers) [CANON]

Sophia made the planets with living powers inside them as **gifts to living things**. The Demiurge did not create them. He **employed** them, giving each an office in his order: assign charts, keep the Wheel turning, and hold what souls forget. They are the civil servants of a cosmic government, which is why their language is bureaucratic (“Intake Window 1”).

Planet	Kosmokrator (working name)	Original gift	Office in the Order	Corruption / what it holds
Moon	Horaios	Dreams, cycles, rest	The Gate: processes the dead, removes memories (the Registry)	Every life’s last day
Mercury	Ailoaios	Speech, messages, learning	Records and transmits the charts	Forgotten words, names, promises
Venus	Astaphaios	Love, beauty, desire	Binds souls to the things they want	Forgotten loves and longings
Sun	Adonaios	Life, identity, warmth	Assigns each soul its “self”	Forgotten pride and selfhood
Mars	Sabaoth	Courage, will, strength	Enforces the Order (the war-arm)	Forgotten anger and violence

Planet	Kosmokrator (working name)	Original gift	Office in the Order	Corruption / what it holds
Jupiter	Iao	Fortune, growth, meaning	Hands out each life's luck and lot	Forgotten hope and greed
Saturn	(the Demiurge's throne)	Structure, endurance	Time itself; the seat of the First Measure	Everything else

The Silent Spheres [DRAFT]

Uranus, Neptune and Pluto exist in Sophia's creation but were **never brought under the Order**. The Demiurge cannot see them clearly. Their influence is rare, wild and does not fit the chart (in gameplay, the Uranus and Neptune Blessings). Late in the story they may be **doors** out of the Wheel. **[OPEN]** Who placed them there: Sophia, or someone else?

PART 4

The origin of humanity

The account [CANON]

- The Demiurge shaped human **bodies from the clay** of Sophia's world. He wanted workers to maintain his Order. (Elias's Ultimate, "First Clay", echoes this.)
- The bodies would not wake. He did not know why.
- To wake them, he **breathed into them the only life he had**: the light he had inherited from his mother, without knowing it was hers.
- The bodies woke, and now carried a **spark from outside his world**. He had given away the one thing he never understood about himself.
- This is why he needs the Wheel: every soul that escapes takes a little of that light out of his universe for good. If everyone left, **he would go dark**. His fear is ideology, survival and loneliness at once.

Messenger souls [DRAFT]

A few souls came **directly** from the Divine Realm: messengers who took bodies and got caught in the Wheel. They remember more easily and dream more vividly. Kairos is the greatest of them. The game never confirms the others. **[OPEN]** Candidates: Dr. Sophia Arden, the Serpent's earliest followers, someone in the Church hierarchy.

Why this matters for themes
Humans are not merely creations. Their bodies belong to the Demiurge; their spark belongs to no one. "Creation vs. ownership" is answered here: making something does not mean owning what lives inside it.

PART 5

How the systems fit together

System	What it really is
Birth chart [CANON]	The **address** of a life inside the Order: when and where the soul entered time, which Kosmokrator supervises which part of it, and which Houses it is filed under. **It describes the conditions of an incarnation, not the soul.** The Church teaches the opposite: "your chart is you".
Planets / Signs / Houses / Aspects	Planets are **offices** (who governs). Signs are **dialects** (how that office speaks to you). Houses are **rooms** (where in your life it acts). Aspects are **relationships between offices** (friction, harmony, opposition). Gameplay echo: Star Fragments literally tune a soul's address.
The Wheel of Return [CANON]	1. Birth: the soul is **filed** (given a chart). 2. A life. 3. Death: at the **Gate of the Moon** (Horaios) the soul is processed. 4. Its memories are **removed** and given to the Kosmokrators to hold. 5. The cleaned soul is sent down again with a new chart.
Lethe	Water from the Wheel's machinery that speeds forgetting. Natural springs exist in the world. Mother Noa's sect drinks it on purpose.
Vices [CANON]	Forgotten memories that overflow from a saturated Kosmokrator, shaped by that planet. Their cores contain real fragments of people. **Every Vice is someone's lost memory.**
Starfall [CANON]	When a Kosmokrator overflows and its held memories fall to Earth as Vices. "The First Starfall" is also the name of the war that began 100 years ago, when the planets were turned against humanity.

System	What it really is
The Blotting [CANON]	An emergency override (20 years ago). The Wheel normally wipes memory at death; the Blotting wipes **during life**: names, faces, history, records. It also **flooded the planets**, which is why Starfalls became far worse in the last 20 years.

Why the Kosmokrators "turned" [CANON]

Not by a curse and not by simple obedience. **They are drowning.** Every forgotten grief, love, shame and lullaby of every life goes to them to hold. Over ages they swelled with humanity's lost memories until their gifts became weapons. When the Demiurge declared war on Gnosis, he did not need to corrupt them: he only had to point their overflow at humanity. Freed for a moment, Horaios says it plainly: *"What you forget does not vanish. It is carried."*

PART 6

Gnosis, and the war over time

What Gnosis is [CANON]

Not learning a secret. **Remembering that you were never only your chart.** Three stages:

- **Remembering**: fragments of past lives surface as déjà vu, dreams and impossible familiarity.
- **Recognizing the spark**: understanding that part of you is not from this world.
- **Unfiling**: the soul stops fitting its chart. The Kosmokrators can no longer fully govern it, and it can act outside the measured Order.

Why the Demiurge fears it [CANON]

- He cannot see beyond his world. To him an unfiled soul vanishes into nothing: Gnosis looks like **a mass-suicide cult**.
- Every awakened soul that leaves takes some of the light he lives on.
- If Gnosis is true, **he is not God**, and he has a mother who left him. He would rather end the world than learn that.

Chronos vs. Kairos [CANON]

The Demiurge rules **measured time**: clocks, orbits, schedules, charts. Kairos is the **unmeasured moment**. In this life he was born **in the minute the clock stopped**: the instant of the Blotting, when time itself was halted. Houses are assigned from the hour of birth, and that minute did not exist in the Order's records. **So he has no Houses**, the system cannot file him, and the Blotting could not fully take his memories. His in-game abilities ("The Unwritten Minute", "Borrowed Hour") are this cosmology made playable.

PART 7

History (the true version)

Each event below also has an **official version** taught by the Concord Church, which differs. Players learn the true version gradually, and in-world documents often contradict each other.

When	What really happened	What the Church teaches
Before time	Sophia creates alone; the Demiurge wakes; he orders the universe and makes time.	The Founder made everything from nothing.
The First Room (Eden)	The first souls are filed into the Wheel. The Serpent tells them "you have forgotten where you came from". Their punishment is not death (death already existed) but the Wheel: never to remember again.	Humanity fell by listening to a demon.
The Tower (Babel)	An early civilization comes close to collective Gnosis. The scattering of languages is **an earlier, smaller Blotting**.	Pride punished.
The Drowning (Flood)	The first recorded overflow of the planets, remembered wrongly as water.	Purification by water.
The Thief of Fire	A Kosmokrator (perhaps Mars, Sabaoth) gives humanity fire, meaning knowledge, against orders and is chained. Possibly still sympathetic to humans.	A rebel spirit, rightly bound.

When	What really happened	What the Church teaches
~100 years ago	**First Gnosis.** Kairos (life A) awakens completely and confronts the Demiurge. War is declared: **the First Starfall**. Life A dies in the war. Meridian becomes “the last city”.	A heretic’s rebellion angered the heavens.
~100 to 20 years ago	Kairos (life B) is reborn and, thanks to his Gnosis, **remembers**. He spends decades rebuilding in secret and founds the memory research the Institute descends from.	Unknown; the records were rewritten.
20 years ago	Life B attempts the **mass awakening**: all of humanity remembering at once. It breaks minds and cities. The Demiurge answers with **the Blotting**, and life B dies in the same instant.	The Blotting is called “the Mercy”.
The same minute	Kairos (life C) is born while time is stopped. No Houses. Unrecorded.	An irregular birth; a defect.
Present (Meridian)	Starfalls every night. The Church, the Council and the Institute each hide part of the truth. Kairos, 20, wakes at 3:00 a.m. from the dream of a clock with no hands.	The planets are angry; keep your Ledger current.

A deliberate grey area
Life B’s mass awakening was **not purely heroic**. Remembering everything at once was more than human minds could bear, and it caused real harm before the Blotting. Kairos must face that his past self was partly wrong, and that the Demiurge was not wrong about everything.

PART 8

The Concord Church: the dirty side

The Concord Church is the official faith of Meridian and is bound to the Concord Council (government). It is a **fictional institution**. The story critiques how institutions use faith to control people (a real theme in Christian history), never faith or believers themselves. Many ordinary believers in the game are kind and sincere; Elias's faith is one of the warmest things in the story. **[CANON]**

Doctrine

- **"Your chart is your calling."** To question your chart is a sin of pride.
- **Forgetting is mercy.** Painful memories are a burden God takes from the faithful. The Blotting is taught as **"the Mercy"**.
- **The Founder is the one true God**, and the planets are his angels. Suffering is the planets' just anger at humanity's rebellion.
- The Serpent is the Adversary; Gnosis is called **"the Old Heresy"**.

Practices (where the rot is)

Practice	What it looks like	What it really does
Indulgences of Forgetting	Pay the Church, confess, and a priest gives you blessed water to forget your sin.	Sells Lethe. The poor keep their guilt; the rich buy clean consciences. The money funds the Council.
The Ledger & Confession	Every citizen keeps a Ledger; confessions are "sealed".	Confessions are copied to the Registry. The state knows everyone's secrets.
The Office of Correction	Protects the faith from heresy.	An inquisition: burns forbidden texts, "re-charts" dissidents (edits their birth records so the Order treats them as someone else).
Re-charting	Corrects "clerical errors" in birth records.	Rewrites who a person is allowed to be. Used on orphans, rebels and inconvenient heirs.
Relics	Sanctified Vice cores sold as protective charms.	Trade in people's lost memories. The Church knows what the cores contain.
Saints of the Mercy	People canonized for "forgiving everything".	Often people who were deliberately made to forget crimes done to them.
The Buried Books	Officially do not exist.	Heretic scriptures hidden in jars beneath old chapels (a nod to the real Nag Hammadi find). The true history is in them.

Factions inside the faith [DRAFT]

- **The hierarchy**: knows part of the truth and protects the Order because it protects their power.
- **Mother Noa's Lethe sect** ("Forget, and be forgiven"): officially fringe, secretly protected. Sincere fanatics who believe forgetting is holiness.
- **Village priests and ordinary believers**: sincere, mostly ignorant of the rot, often its first victims.
- **The Serpent's followers** (Gnostic heretics): right about much, but some are as dogmatic as the Church.

PART 9

Layers of truth

The player passes through four levels of understanding. Each one reframes the last. Never reveal a layer early. **[CANON]**

Layer	What it says	Who believes it
1. Church	The planets are angry because humanity rebelled. Obey your chart. Forgetting is mercy.	Most of Meridian at the start.
2. Heresy	The planets are jailers. The Founder is a false god. Remember everything.	The Serpent's followers; the player around mid-game.
3. Truth	The Demiurge is sincere, lonely and afraid. The planets were gifts turned wardens, drowning in our memories. Sophia made it all and stepped away.	Revealed in the late game.
4. Beneath	Neither side is fully right. Remembering everything at once broke the world. The outside is real but formless and frightening. The answer is not to destroy or keep the Wheel, but to let each soul **choose**.	The ending.

PART 10

Where the story is going (endgame direction)

The Choice: Wake or Stay [CANON]

The ending is a mix of escape and repair. When the Wheel is opened, **every soul is offered a choice**: **wake** (remember, unfile, and be free to leave the Physical Realm) or **stay** (remain in the world with its order and its forgetting, by their own will). Like the final choice in *Alice in Borderland*, staying is not shameful. It becomes honest instead of imposed.

- The world is not destroyed. Those who stay inherit a **reformed** order: charts still describe conditions, but no longer define a soul.
- The Kosmokrators release what they carried. Memories return to those who choose them.
- The Demiurge is offered the same choice, and chooses to go to his mother. **[CANON]**
- Kairos and the Serpent become one. What Kairos chooses (wake, or stay with the people he loves) is **[OPEN]**.

Character arc of Kairos [DRAFT]

Life C begins as "the boy with no Houses", a defect. Across the game he learns that he is the missing half of an Aeon, that his past selves made heroic and terrible choices, and that a person is not their chart, their past, or even their memories alone. His final question is not "who was I?" but **"who do I choose to be now?"**

PART 11

Mysteries and reveals ledger

Each mystery is listed with where to plant it and when it pays off. Chapters are approximate.

Mystery	Early hint	Middle	Reveal
Who is the Serpent?	A voice in Kairos's dreams: "You were there."	It finishes Kairos's thoughts; old texts call it "the Other Half".	A sliver of Kairos left outside time (late game).
Who is Kairos?	No Houses; dreams of a clock with no hands.	Life A and life B are revealed.	Sophia's partner Aeon (late game).
Was the First Starfall his fault?	Records blame a heretic.	The Demiurge declared the war.	Both: life A's awakening shook the planets loose.
Has the Blotting happened before?	Babel legend in a children's book.	Buried Books describe earlier "silences".	Yes. This may not be the first cycle. **[OPEN]**
Barnabas's photograph	Face down on his desk (Ch1).	His family is in a Vice core.	Memories can be returned to people.
Dr. Sophia Arden	Notes on her arm; a missing year.	She helped build the memory machine.	Why she was named Sophia (a messenger soul?) **[OPEN]**
Horaios was "written over"	Ch1 ending line.	Other Kosmokrators show edits too.	The Demiurge edits minds, possibly his own.
Did the Demiurge Blot himself?	—	He has no memory of his own beginning.	He erased the memory of his mother. **[DRAFT]**
Kairos's wall of notes	Some lines are not in his handwriting.	The handwriting matches life B's research.	Life B left messages for his next self.

Mystery	Early hint	Middle	Reveal
The Silent Spheres	Uranus/Neptune Blessings feel “wrong”.	The Demiurge cannot see them.	Doors out of the Wheel. **[OPEN]**

PART 12

Present-day cast and how they touch the myth

Current names; renaming is planned with the Chapter 1 rewrite.

Character	Role now	Mythic thread
Kairos	Main character, Vigil vanguard, 20	Sophia's partner Aeon; lives A, B and C; the Unrecorded.
Seren	Vigil marksman, 21	Parents were Vigil and never came home. Her arc is about grief she refuses to forget.
Elias	Vigil guardian, 18, raised by a chapel	Raised by Mother Noa. His real parents' memory was taken from him. Faith vs. the institution.
Dr. Sophia Arden	Memory scientist, 24	Missing year; helped build the memory machine; possibly a messenger soul.
Cyrus Crane	Council member, Chancellor's son, 22	Inside the system that does the hiding; Re-charting may have been used on him.
Barnabas	Vigil captain	Wants to forget his dead family; betrays the crew in Ch1.
Mother Noa	Leader of the Lethe sect	Sincere fanatic; Elias's adoptive mother; Marr's teacher.
Chancellor Crane	Head of the Concord Council	Knows more of the truth than anyone in Meridian.
Dr. Ezekiel Marr	Institute scientist	Turns memory research into a weapon; makes Vices.
Horaios	Kosmokrator of the Moon (Ch1 boss)	Keeper of the Gate; "written over"; first to wake.

PART 13

Open questions

- Final naming pass for characters, Kosmokrators and places (planned with the Chapter 1 rewrite).
- What Kairos himself chooses at the end: wake or stay.
- How many Blotting cycles have happened.
- Who placed the Silent Spheres.
- Whether Dr. Sophia Arden is a messenger soul, and how close she is to the Aeon Sophia.
- How much the player directly sees of the Divine Realm (recommended: almost nothing until the very end).

PART 14

Glossary

Term	Meaning
Aeon	A divine being of the Divine Realm; exists in pairs.
Blotting, the	The curse of 20 years ago that wipes memory during life. The Church calls it "the Mercy".
Chronos	Measured time; the Demiurge's power.
Concord Church	Meridian's official faith, bound to the Concord Council.
Demiurge	The being Sophia created alone; orderer of the Physical Realm. Church: "the Founder", "the First Measure".
Gnosis	Remembering that you are more than your chart; three stages: remember, recognize, unfile.
Kairos	The decisive moment; also the Aeon who is Sophia's partner, and the main character.

Term	Meaning
Kosmokrator	A planetary ruler serving the Order. Heretics say “Archon”.
Ledger	Every citizen’s personal record book.
Lethe	Water of forgetting from the Wheel’s machinery.
Monad	The unknowable source of all existence.
Re-charting	The Church’s practice of rewriting a person’s birth record.
Serpent, the	A sliver of Kairos’s consciousness left outside time.
Silent Spheres	Uranus, Neptune, Pluto: outside the Order.
Starfall	A planet overflowing with forgotten memories; also the war begun 100 years ago.
Unfiling	The third stage of Gnosis: no longer governed by one’s chart.
Vice	An overflowing forgotten memory given monstrous form.
Wheel of Return	The cycle of filing, living, dying, forgetting and rebirth.